

Jiaqi (Jacky) Zheng

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Appointment

Peking University, HSBC Business School	2025–Present
Assistant Professor of Finance	
University of Oxford, Saïd Business School	Since 2025
Research Affiliate	

Education

University of Oxford, Saïd Business School	2019-2025
DPhil in Finance (with No Corrections)	
VU Amsterdam and Tinbergen Institute	2017-2019
MSc in Economics (with Distinction)	

Publications

Equity-Based Compensation and the Timing of Share Repurchases: The Role of the Corporate Calendar
(with Ingolf Dittmann, Amy Yazhu Li, and Stefan Obernberger)
Journal of Accounting and Economics (2025): 101798.
Featured in: *Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance*

Working Papers

Public Policy and Private-Sector Prosocial Motives: The Case of Greenhouse Gas Emissions [SSRN Link](#)
Abstract: *Do public policies always promote corporate prosocial behaviour? I propose that their effectiveness depends on their interactions with private-sector intrinsic motives. I examine how shareholder pressure to reduce emissions responds to the adoption of greenhouse gas reduction targets in several U.S. states. Using a difference-in-differences approach, I find that firms in adopting states experience reduced shareholder pressure, as reflected in fewer emission-related shareholder proposals and lower voting support. Furthermore, I find no evidence that these policies reduce corporate emissions. These findings suggest that, under certain circumstances, public interventions can inadvertently crowd out private-sector prosocial efforts, thereby undermining their intended effects.*

Runner-Up, 5th Annual Sustainable Finance in Fixed Income Research Competition

Presented at: ARCS Annual Research Conference 2026 (scheduled), CREDIT Venice 2025, Future Scholars in Finance Forum 2025, Liechtenstein Workshop of Sustainable Finance, 3rd London Political Finance Workshop, Sixth Edinburgh Corporate Finance Conference, Hong Kong-Shenzhen Joint Finance Research Workshop 2025, HKU Governance and Sustainability PhD Workshop 2025, FMA European Doctoral Student Consortium 2025, Junior Academics Research Seminars in Finance 2024-25, Xiamen University, Nanyang Technological University, City University of Hong Kong, Lingnan University, Peking University, and the University of Oxford

Powerful CEOs in Uncertain Times: Survival of the Fittest [SSRN Link](#)

Abstract: *Contrary to the conventional focus on the costs of excessive CEO power, this study investigates whether powerful CEOs are beneficial and desirable under uncertainty. The evidence shows that powerful CEOs have a lower dismissal rate in uncertain times. As they exhibit better performance but no increased compensation, powerful CEOs are likely retained optimally for their effectiveness rather than by entrenched power. To mitigate endogeneity concerns surrounding CEO power, this paper utilizes the onset of COVID-19 pandemic as an unanticipated sudden spike in uncertainty, during which*

CEO power is unlikely to adjust swiftly to external conditions due to stickiness. The study proposes two potential mechanisms explaining why powerful CEOs are more effective under uncertainty: their willingness to share information with the board and their capability to take swift action. Overall, this study challenges the view that CEO power is always manipulative and detrimental.

Presented at: 2024 AEA, 2023 AFA Poster, and University of Oxford (Best PhD Paper Award)

Teaching Experience

Saïd Business School, University of Oxford

Financial Markets, MSc Finance, Lecturer; Evaluation: 96.11/100	2025
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Saïd Business School, University of Oxford

Corporate Finance, MSc Financial Economics, TA; Evaluation: 4.88/5	2023
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Final Integrative Assignment, Executive Diploma in Financial Strategy, Tutor; No evaluation available	2023
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Financial Analysis, BA in Economics & Management, Tutor; No evaluation available	2022
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Research Internships, UNIQ+, TA; No evaluation available	2021
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(For undergraduate students from underrepresented and disadvantaged backgrounds)

The Business of Big Data, MBA, TA; Evaluation: 5/5	2020
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Grants, Awards, and Honors

Runner-Up, 5th Annual Sustainable Finance in Fixed Income Research Competition	2025
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EFA PhD Student Travel Grant, European Finance Association	2023
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AFA PhD Student Travel Grant, American Finance Association	2023
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Best PhD Paper Award in Finance, Saïd Business School, University of Oxford	2023
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Conference Travel Grant, Saïd Business School, University of Oxford	2022
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Full Scholarship, University of Oxford	2019
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TECT Research Grant, Templeton Education and Charity Trust	2019
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Full Scholarship, Tinbergen Institute	2017
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Full Scholarship, Tongji University	2014
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Other Experience

De Nederlandsche Bank	2018 - 2019
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Risk Management Analyst (part-time)

Skills and Interests

Software: Python, Stata, R, MATLAB

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent)

Interests: Rowing, Classical Singing, Travelling